

that were filed provisionally under seal.

2. In addition, the Court orders the parties to meet and confer within two weeks of notice of entry of this order regarding all other pending motions to seal, including, but not limited to, the 1/6/26 Motion to Seal and the 2/25/26 Motion to Seal. If agreeable, the parties shall promptly prepare and submit a single Stipulation and Order regarding the granting of all such motions for the Court's review and approval.
3. The Court shall issue the order after hearing.

3. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C24-03088

CASE NAME: SHEILA WOODRUFF VS. FCA US, LLC.

***HEARING ON MOTION FOR DISCOVERY COMPEL PLAINTIFF SHEILA WOODRUFF'S DEPOSITION AND PRODUCTION OF DOCUMENTS**

FILED BY: FCA US, LLC.

TENTATIVE RULING:

Defendant FCA US LLC ("Defendant") filed a Motion to Compel Plaintiff Sheila Woodruff's Deposition and Production of Documents and Request for Monetary Sanctions on April 22, 2026 (the "Motion to Compel Deposition"). The Motion to Compel Deposition was initially set for hearing on November 9, 2026. By the Court's Order issued May 7, 2026, the motion was advanced for hearing on June 29, 2026. The motion is opposed.

Plaintiff Sheila Woodruff ("Plaintiff") filed opposition papers on June 16, 2026. The Court exercises its discretion to consider these papers.

Reply papers were filed on June 22, 2026.

Background

Plaintiff initially noticed the deposition of Plaintiff for February 26, 2025, along with certain document production requests. See Declaration of Jennah Feeley filed April 22, 2026 ("Feeley Decl."), ¶13 and **Exhibit A** thereto.

After objections were served indicating Plaintiff's unavailability and interposing various objections to the document production requests, but no action was taken until the deposition was re-noticed for February 24, 2026. See Feeley Decl., ¶¶13-5.

A new set of objections was served on March 10, 2026. Feeley Decl., ¶16 and **Exhibit E** thereto.

A Second Amended Notice of Deposition followed. Feeley Decl., ¶17 and **Exhibit F** thereto.

A further set of objections was served on March 18, 2026. Feeley Decl., ¶19 and **Exhibit H** thereto. As Plaintiff had done before, the objections asserted that the date was unavailable for their side and noted that the date had been chosen without consultation. See Feeley Decl., Plaintiff's Objections dated March 18, 2026, **Exhibit H** ("This deposition was unilaterally noticed by Defendant for a date and time on which Plaintiff and/or Plaintiff's counsel is unavailable.").

The moving party's declaration corroborates this assertion, and it appears Defendant just kept re-noticing dates of its own choosing. See Feeley Decl., ¶15 *et seq.*

Analysis

As described in the opposition declaration, it appears that the parties have “reached a written agreement confirming the date of Plaintiff’s deposition.” Declaration of Tasha-Luna Khatchadourian filed June 16, 2026 (“Khatchadourian Decl.”), ¶16.

While the matter appears moot, Defendant’s reply indicates that it is persisting in this motion because “Plaintiff’s firm has a pattern and practice of avoiding deposition.” This relies on assertions about Plaintiff’s counsel practices in other litigation.

This Court is not going to embark on the exercise of attempting to evaluate the parties’ relative efforts to coordinate depositions in multiple other cases. See Declaration of Kirsten McNelly Bibbes filed April 22, 2026.

What the Court can glean from the description of the efforts in this case is that Defendant’s counsel contributed the stalemate and delay regarding the setting of the deposition.

Although the deposition notices were each time accompanied by a letter requesting “alternative availability,” such requests came with extraordinary short timeframes for the demanded responses. See e.g. Feeley Decl., **Exhibits D and G**. One does not make “every effort” “to resolve any disputes” by unilaterally setting deposition dates and then demanding each time that alternative dates be provided within a scant few days of the “meet and confer” letter. See e.g. Feeley Decl., **Exhibit G** (emailed meet and confer letter dated March 16, 2026 demanding response “by no later than March 18, 2026...”).

Plaintiff’s counsel certainly also contributed to the impasse and delay by relying on repeated objections without themselves engaging in robust efforts to reach out and follow up to find a mutual convenient date for the deposition—at least before whatever last minute discussions led, finally, to the current date being set.

This impasse might well have been solved by simply picking up a phone and conferring on a deposition date. Neither side, it seems, was willing to break the ongoing stalemate by making a truly earnest effort to do so.

Disposition

The Court finds and orders as follows:

1. The Motion to Compel Deposition is DENIED. All requests for sanctions are DENIED.
2. The Court shall issue the order after hearing.

4. 9:00 AM CASE NUMBER: C24-03337
CASE NAME: MARICRUZ DIMAS-MARTINEZ VS. HELIO DIMAS
HEARING ON SUMMARY MOTION
FILED BY: DIMAS-MARTINEZ, MARICRUZ
TENTATIVE RULING:

Before the Court is Plaintiff Maricruz Dimas-Martinez’s Motion for Summary Judgment.

Plaintiff’s MSJ was filed on February 17, 2026, with a hearing date set for June 29, 2026. As such, any opposition as due on or before June 9, 2026. (Code Civ. Proc. § 437c (b)(2).) As of the date of the